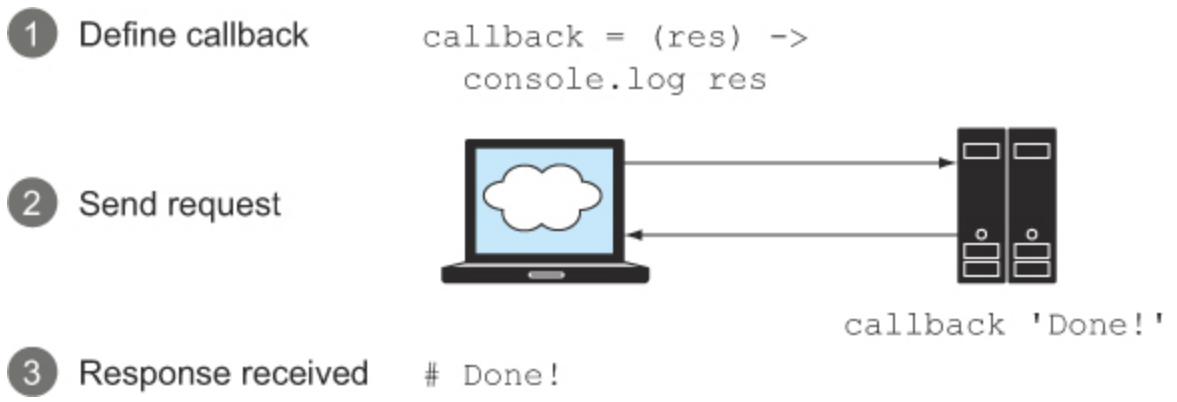
Figure 3.3. A callback from an external server



The sequence diagram in figure 3.3 is more complicated than the callback you write. Now, the data.js file contains the number of party attendees and *you can get the contents of that file* with the `get` method, which does some Ajax for you. All this means that you can use `setInterval` to regularly trigger a fetch of the latest attendee every second and display that in the HTML page. Here's the document again:

```
<!doctype html>
<title>How many people are coming?</title>
<script src='attendees.js'></script>
<body>
<div id='how-many-attendees'>How many attendees?</div>
</body>
</html>
```

Finally, here's the client-side script that brings all of this together:

```
showAttendees = ->
  url = "http://www.coffeescriptinaction.com/3/data.js"
  get url, (response) ->
    outputElement = document.querySelector("#how-many-attendees")
    outputElement.innerHTML = "#{response} attendees!"

setInterval(showAttendees, 1000)
```

The callback inserts the contents of data.js into the web page.

Request that showAttendees be invoked every 1000 milliseconds.

It took a while to get there, but that's how things work in a web browser. How about on Node.js then? Luckily, it works the same way.

3.3.2. Event-driven file reading with Node.js